

Scenario 3: Monitoring streamflow when heavy rains are forecasted

Description

You are an emergency manager who would like to use FloodSavvy as a source of forecasted information to assess potential flooding risks from heavy rainfall.

Your Task

- Select your region from the HOME page or from the dropdown on the MAPS page. Zoom in to find a river of interest and click the river to select it.
- Use the Forecast Data feature (button found at the top left of the page) to view projected streamflow over the next 10-days for the river.

**Note: The forecast data is based on model runs where the NWM is executed six times using nearly identical starting conditions, with slight variations introduced to account for uncertainty in the modeling process. These runs produce six different forecast outputs, known as ensemble members. In this version, we are only showing results from the first member, which provides hourly forecasts from now through the next 10 days. In future updates, we plan to include all six types of forecasts to illustrate how uncertainty can evolve over time and how similar or different the outcomes may be. This will help emphasize the importance of producing reliable forecasts, not just accurate ones.*

- You may want to compare the forecasted streamflow values to historical values (details in Scenario 1) to contextualize the present conditions. If you are concerned that your region may be impacted by flooding from heavy rains:
 - Check official weather alerts and guidance on the National Weather Service website and consider contacting your local Weather Forecast Office.
 - View additional forecasted information, including observed forecasts on gauged rivers and 30-day estimates, on the National Water Model. If there is forecasted flooding, you will also be able to view modelled Flood Inundation Maps. The NWM tutorial, found on the 'National Water Model Resources' page, provides steps on how to access this information.
- Please note that information on FloodSavvy and the National Water Model is updated hourly.